



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



CVE-2025-68686 Fortinet FortiOS Sensitive Information Exposure Under Active Exploitation

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2025-68686 Fortinet FortiOS Sensitive Information Exposure Under Active Exploitation - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

CISA added CVE-2025-68686 to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog on 2026-07-27, making Fortinet FortiOS an emergency edge-device remediation priority for defenders today. Public CVE/NVD summaries describe the issue as exposure of sensitive information to an unauthorized actor in multiple FortiOS release branches, with the specific risk that crafted HTTP requests may bypass a prior patch for a symbolic-link persistence mechanism observed in post-exploitation cases.

The operational risk is concentrated on FortiGate/FortiOS systems that terminate VPN, security edge, or management workflows. Even where the bug is characterized as information disclosure rather than direct code execution, exposed secrets, configuration data, or persistence artifacts can materially improve attacker access, re-entry, and lateral movement options.

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
CVE	CVE-2025-68686
Product / Component	Fortinet FortiOS
Weakness	CWE-200 exposure of sensitive information to an unauthorized actor
Severity	CISA KEV active exploitation; prioritize as emergency edge-device remediation
Affected Versions	FortiOS 7.6.0-7.6.1, 7.4.0-7.4.6, 7.2 all versions, 7.0 all versions, 6.4 all versions per NVD/CVE summaries
Fixed Versions	Validate against Fortinet PSIRT guidance and current FortiOS branch advisories
Disclosure / KEV Date	CISA KEV date added: 2026-07-27
Exploitation Status	Known exploited in the wild per CISA KEV

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
CISA KEV catalog	Confirms known exploitation and federal remediation due date of 2026-08-10	High
NVD CVE detail	Provides weakness, version-range, and description context	High
CVE.org record	Confirms CNA-style vulnerability description and affected FortiOS branches	High
SentinelOne / security-news coverage	Provides defender-facing edge-device risk context	Medium

The active-exploitation status is high confidence because it is drawn from CISA KEV. Version and fix details should be validated against Fortinet PSIRT before change execution because edge-device advisories can be updated after KEV publication.

4. Vulnerability Details

Public summaries describe crafted HTTP requests that may let a remote unauthenticated attacker bypass a patch for a symbolic-link persistence mechanism. The likely defender concern is not only immediate disclosure but the possibility that the disclosed material or bypassed mechanism supports renewed persistence on previously targeted FortiOS appliances.

5. Attack Scenarios

- An actor targets internet-facing FortiOS management or VPN surfaces to obtain sensitive appliance data useful for credential theft or re-entry.
- An actor returns to a previously compromised FortiOS estate and attempts to bypass remediation intended to remove symbolic-link persistence.
- An actor chains appliance-level disclosure with valid credentials, VPN access, or management-plane exposure to move from edge access into internal networks.

6. Threat Landscape & Exploitation Status

CISA KEV inclusion means defenders should treat exploitation as observed, not theoretical. Fortinet edge devices are historically attractive to espionage and ransomware affiliates because they concentrate remote access, routing, and authentication functions.

7. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure Pattern	Why It Matters
Internet-facing FortiOS VPN / management	Highest urgency because attacker reachability is direct.
FortiOS appliances with previous compromise history	Symbolic-link persistence language makes re-entry and incomplete remediation a key concern.
Internal-only appliances	Lower external reachability, but still important where management networks are reachable from partner, VPN, or admin workstations.

8. Mitigation and Workarounds

1. Validate Fortinet PSIRT fixed versions for every FortiOS branch in use and schedule emergency upgrades for internet-facing systems.
2. Review CISA KEV due date tracking and require exception sign-off for any appliance that cannot be patched before 2026-08-10.
3. Audit appliance configuration, admin accounts, API keys, VPN users, and persistence indicators after upgrade rather than treating patching alone as eradication.
4. Restrict management interfaces to dedicated admin networks and enforce MFA for all remote administrative access.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unexpected HTTP requests to FortiOS management endpoints	Reverse proxy, firewall, FortiGate logs	Surface exploitation attempts against management/VPN surfaces.
Appliance configuration export, admin-account changes, or unusual login source	FortiGate event logs / SIEM	Identify post-disclosure account or configuration abuse.

New or suspicious symbolic-link or persistence artifacts	Appliance triage / vendor-recommended checks	Validate eradication of previously observed persistence.
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9.2. Hunt Query

<pre>DeviceNetworkEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where RemoteUrl has_any ("fortinet", "fortigate") or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("fortigate", "fortios") summarize Events=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, InitiatingProcessFileName order by Events desc</pre>
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10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If FortiOS edge devices were probed or exploited, analysts may observe unusual administrative source IPs, configuration access, or management-plane traffic shortly before internal VPN or administrator-account anomalies.

10.2. Hunt Query

<pre>SigninLogs where TimeGenerated > ago(30d) where AppDisplayName has_any ("VPN", "Fortinet", "FortiGate") or ResourceDisplayName has_any ("VPN", "Fortinet", "FortiGate") summarize Attempts=count(), Failures=countif(ResultType != 0), FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated), LastSeen=max(TimeGenerated) by UserPrincipalName, IPAddress, AppDisplayName order by Failures desc</pre>

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Internet-facing edge services are the likely exploitation surface.
T1552	Unsecured Credentials	Sensitive information disclosure may expose secrets or configuration data.
T1133	External Remote Services	FortiOS commonly supports VPN/remote access workflows that attackers may abuse after disclosure.

12. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction was performed. Validation completed in this automation run was source corroboration, report QA rendering, and PDF text extraction.

13. Recommended Actions Summary

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	Network / infrastructure	Inventory exposed FortiOS systems and validate fixed-version path.
Critical	SOC	Hunt for unusual FortiOS administrative access and post-patch persistence symptoms.
High	IAM	Rotate credentials and API keys that may

		have transited affected appliances.
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14. References

- CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog entry for CVE-2025-68686.
- NVD CVE-2025-68686 vulnerability detail.
- CVE.org CVE-2025-68686 record.
- SentinelOne vulnerability database summary for CVE-2025-68686.